

Murder Mystery

Dinner Party 2026



Cary Crates

The Meridian Museum

October 30, 2026 / Private player packet / 1 of 12

INTRODUCTIONS



Cary Crates

Senior Art Handler & Installation Specialist

Cary knows which crate holds a masterpiece and which one holds the extension cords. Cary is the person trusted to move objects worth more than the building without dropping either.

- Works daily with **Chip Patina**.
- Has developed mutual respect with **Frank Lloyd Wrong** despite arguing about impossible installation drawings.
- **Al Baster** likes Cary because Cary actually knows how heavy sculpture is.

ACTING TIPS

Grounded, competent, laconic, surprisingly funny when you choose to speak.

YOUR INTRODUCTION / READ THE BOX ALOUD

I'm Cary Crates. I move priceless objects for a living. Please do not test that sentence by handing me your drink.

Continue to your private briefing on page 3. Keep the packet facing you.



Behind the portrait

Your grievance with Grant

Grant saw you damage a minor frame during installation and threatened to have you fired after the gala, despite the damage being repairable.

Your other secret

You concealed the crack with a reversible mount until Chip could inspect it after opening night.

Conversations to start

- Ask Chip Patina whether the minor frame damage can be repaired after the gala.
- Ask Frank Lloyd Wrong which installation needs your attention before the unveiling.

One attending guest committed the murder alone. Follow your printed account during the hearings. If a named guest is absent, speak to someone else.

By now, you should have drawn a secret animal. Memorize it and don't share it with anyone. This animal is YOUR key to knowing whether you are the murderer or innocent tonight. This will tell you which sections of this packet you can read out loud.



**STOP! Do not turn the page yet.
Wait for the host to announce the next round.**



The game is afoot

The Meridian Museum has its share of secrets, rumors, and lost paperwork. Sixteen numbered envelopes are hidden around the museum. Their contents may significantly help you tonight. These 3 hints lead to 3 different hiding places. If you find an envelope, bring it to your seat at the table. The guest with the most envelopes will win a special prize. You may investigate together.

- 1 *A chair made of metal is sitting on information.*
- 2 *A cabinet for household supplies has accepted a mysterious new donation.*
- 3 *The highest point of the vehicle entrance conceals some information.*



STOP! Do not turn the page yet.
Wait for the host to announce the next round.



Cary Crates

Questions for the room

Choose a named guest who has not answered. Skip absent names. Ask their question; they answer from page 6, then choose the next guest.

Artie Ficial / Monet Bags / Tess Tament

What did Grant demand from you, and what had you already concealed?

Claire O'Scuro / Chip Patina / Sue Venir

What did Grant pressure you to approve or overlook?

Hugh Bidder / Elon Mosaic / Saul D. Bid

What hidden transaction made Grant a threat to you?

Dada DiCapo / Vincent Van Faux / Drew Conclusions

How did Grant threaten your work or reputation?

Dr. Art E. Fact / Reed DeLabel / Justin Tyme

What truth did Grant want suppressed, and what could embarrass you?

Barb Dwyer / Paige Turner / Faye Stop

What did Grant ask you to hide?

Frank Lloyd Wrong / Al Baster / Minnie Malist

What compromise in your work gave Grant leverage over you?

Mona Lott / Elle Loominate / Robin Banks

What did you want returned or protected?

Anya Tique / Ella Gance / Penny Pincher

What past agreement was about to become a public dispute?

Brie DeVivre / Cary Crates / Anne E. Dote

How did Grant threaten your work, and how did you respond?

Your speaking box is on page 6. Turn only within this act.



Cary Crates

Your answer

Read only the bordered words when asked. Keep your packet facing you.
After answering, ask an unheard guest their question from the previous page.

IF INNOCENT

I concealed a repairable frame crack with a reversible mount. I should have reported it. Grant wanted an undamaged delivery record for the photographs, even after he had seen the crack. That would leave my name on an account neither of us believed. I was angry with him and with myself for making the omission he expected me to sign.

IF MURDERER

I concealed a repairable frame crack with a reversible mount. I should have reported it. Grant wanted an undamaged delivery record for the photographs, even after he had seen the crack. He was satisfied as long as the damage stayed out of sight. I would still be the handler whose name was on the record when it was found.



STOP! Do not turn the page yet.
Wait for the host to announce the next round.



Cary Crates

Questions for the room

Choose a named guest who has not answered. Skip absent names. Ask their question; they answer from page 8, then choose the next guest.

Artie Ficial / Paige Turner / Justin Tyme

What task or errand occupied you before the toast?

Claire O'Scuro / Vincent Van Faux / Saul D. Bid

How did you approach Grant about your papers or work?

Hugh Bidder / Tess Tament / Anya Tique / Ella Gance

When did you first enter, and what business did you have with Grant?

Monet Bags / Brie DeVivre / Robin Banks

Describe your errand at the private service station.

Chip Patina / Al Baster / Cary Crates

What physical work or problem occupied you?

Dada DiCapo / Dr. Art E. Fact / Elon Mosaic

What did Grant want changed, and how did you respond before the toast?

Sue Venir / Elle Loominate / Reed DeLabel

Why did you contact the preparation department, and how did you collect your papers?

Barb Dwyer / Frank Lloyd Wrong / Minnie Malist

What practical museum duty were you handling?

Mona Lott / Drew Conclusions / Penny Pincher

What did you bring Grant, and what happened when you delivered it?

Anne E. Dote / Faye Stop

How did your museum materials bring you through the preparation department?

Your speaking box is on page 8. Turn only within this act.



Cary Crates

Your answer

Read only the bordered words when asked. Keep your packet facing you.
After answering, ask an unheard guest their question from the previous page.

IF INNOCENT

I delivered the boxed donor glass from the shop to the service manager, then went back to the damaged frame. I had hidden its crack with the packing blanket. The freight lift failed while I was moving the trolley, and I stayed with the work until the mechanic released it. Grant wanted the delivery recorded as undamaged. I had already failed to report the crack; I was being asked to turn that omission into a signed condition report.

IF MURDERER

I delivered the boxed donor glass from the shop to the service manager, then went back to the damaged frame. I had hidden its crack with the packing blanket. The freight lift failed while I was moving the trolley, and I stayed with the work until the mechanic released it. Grant wanted the delivery recorded as undamaged. I had already failed to report the crack; I was being asked to turn that omission into a signed condition report.



STOP! Do not turn the page yet.
Wait for the host to announce the next round.



Cary Crates

Questions for the room

Choose a named guest who has not answered. Skip absent names. Ask their question; they answer from page 10, then choose the next guest.

Claire O'Scuro / Sue Venir / Dr. Art E. Fact

What detail on your paperwork or its packaging should we notice?

Artie Ficial / Tess Tament / Minnie Malist

What did you handle around the speech or service preparations?

Hugh Bidder / Elon Mosaic / Saul D. Bid

What original record or material completes your account of the dispute?

Chip Patina / Al Baster / Cary Crates

Which retained record or material explains the work or problem you described?

Dada DiCapo / Vincent Van Faux / Elle Loominate

What physical detail completes your account of the work you wanted protected?

Monet Bags / Anya Tique / Penny Pincher

What was on the material you brought, and what does it actually record?

Barb Dwyer / Brie DeVivre / Robin Banks

What did your access or service arrangements actually involve?

Paige Turner / Drew Conclusions / Faye Stop

Which original or retained material did you handle, and what marks does it bear?

Frank Lloyd Wrong / Reed DeLabel / Anne E. Dote

What does the completed work or return record tell us?

Mona Lott / Ella Gance / Justin Tyme

What retained paper or record supports your account, and what does it disclose?

Your speaking box is on page 10. Turn only within this act.



Cary Crates

Your answer

Read only the bordered words when asked. Keep your packet facing you.
After answering, ask an unheard guest their question from the previous page.

IF INNOCENT

The shop's delivery slip identifies the boxed donor glass handed to the service manager. The frame's repair estimate and the mechanic's lift record concern a different object. I had concealed the crack before the lift fault. The estimate records that damage, including when I first saw it. I should have filed it instead of hoping a reversible mount would turn it into somebody else's discovery.

IF MURDERER

I had delivered the boxed donor glass to the service manager. Later, when I brought the trolley through the salon, the glass was unwrapped near the edge of Grant's table. I moved it farther in before taking the trolley past. I was still wearing the work gloves I had used on the preparation walkthrough. The inventory records a foil-backed red scrap caught inside one glove's cuff. The repair estimate concerns the frame crack I concealed. Grant wanted the photographs to show an undamaged delivery; the blanket did not make the damage disappear.



STOP! Do not turn the page yet.
Wait for the host to announce the next round.



Cary Crates

Your ballot

Choose one attending guest. Explain your accusation in your own words. Detach this page and give only the ballot to the host for tallying. Keep your packet for Coming Clean.

Your character name

I accuse

Why? Motive, evidence and any unresolved contradiction

Best Actor

Best Costume



The last word

Read only when the host calls you. Top three suspects read first. Use your own role's box; keep every other word private.

IF INNOCENT / READ ALOUD WHEN CALLED

I concealed the frame crack before the lift fault. The shop's glass delivery and the mechanic's record concern different objects; the repair estimate records the damage I hid. I did not kill Grant. I will report the crack with the actual date I saw it. A careful delivery afterward does not make the earlier omission disappear.

IF MURDERER / READ ALOUD WHEN CALLED

I took cyanide during the preparation walkthrough and poisoned Grant's uncovered glass in the salon. Moving it out of the trolley's path gave me an ordinary reason to handle it. A fragment of the bottle's custody band caught inside my work-glove cuff; another was found inside the glass. The inventory and laboratory comparison linked the material, and I had admitted wearing those gloves at both places. He ordered the frame damage concealed and threatened to blame me. I killed him instead of reporting the crack.

Every selected suspect gets their final word.